

Baron's SA Lead Dwindles After 8-6 Loss To Mobile

By UNITED PRESS

They had a zany schedule in the Southern Association last night and down to the wire it looked as if the results might be even zanier.

In Birmingham, it was John Jacink versus Mobile and in Atlanta, Vic Rehm against New Orleans, and but for a little, the one-man gang duo could be boasting victories today.

Jaciuk, the Barons' 24-year-old first sacker, slammed three home runs good for all six Birmingham runs, in an 8-6 loss to Mobile. The lefthand-hitting Wyandotte, Mich., native also stroked a double as the slagtowners saw their Southern lead dwindle to three percentage points over idle Memphis.

Atlanta's 20-year-old mound sensation, Rehm, went eight innings and allowed the Pels only two hits in a 2-1, 11 inning thriller. His Cracker teammates, meantime, "supported" him by leaving the sacks jammed in three of the first four frames. The fireballing lefthander, in his last 24 innings, has allowed but two runs and in return, has gotten only two from Clyde King's slumping stickmen.

Elsewhere in the league last night, rain washed out games at Nashville where the Vols were hosting Memphis and at Chatta-

nooga where Little Rock was hoping to take further steps out of the Southern cellar.

The Birmingham setback actually dropped the Barons a full game behind idle Memphis though on an official percentage basis they still lead by 3 points.

New Orleans scored in the first frame on Jim Rice's walk, an infield out and Emil Panko's single but from then on Rehm was the complete master. In the eighth, Jim Frey was sent to the plate for him and delivered a game tying double.

In the 11th, the Pels loaded the bases off reliever Charley Bicknell and New Orleans Manager Andy Cohen called for the squeeze. Second baseman Earl Weaver responded with a perfect bunt which easily scored John Powers from third with the winning run.

New Orleans' George Witt, who went 11 innings, gave up 8 hits but struck out 9 and was particularly tough in the clutch. Altogether, Atlanta left 17 runners stranded. Relief pitcher Les Phillips got the win in a one inning stint and Bicknell was the loser.

Tonight, it's the same slate with Memphis in Nashville, Little Rock at Chattanooga, Mobile in Birmingham and New Orleans visiting Atlanta.